

it and is engaging with the US administration, Anthropic and vendors who have been given a chance to test Mythos to see what steps India should take." CERT-In warned that frontier AI systems with advanced cyber capabilities could lower the barrier for malicious actors, automate exploitation workflows and scale cyber campaigns.

The urgency of the situation has triggered alarm through many layers of officialdom. "It may affect markets, banking and payments," a senior government official said. "The concern is not just breach, it is system-wide impact." That is not language used lightly. Officials have reportedly sought access to better understand Mythos's capabilities. Regulators have been asked to engage counterparts in the US, UK and Europe. The Prime Minister's Office is said to be tracking developments closely, with CERT-In and the National Security Adviser's office coordinating security guardrails. "With Mythos knocking on the doors, the need for deeper coordination across global bodies has become urgent," an official said.

Why the Panic

Earlier AI tools could assist humans. They could generate code, automate tasks, help defenders or even aid attackers. Mythos is seen as going further by combining reasoning, vulnerability discovery and autonomous execution. Nasscom chairman Srikanth Velamakanni, who is also the co-founder and Group CEO of Fractal Analytics, a frontline AI company, says, "Earlier, even though they were good at reasoning and answering questions, they were not really able to accomplish any real-world tasks with great accuracy. Now, that's changing. Not only can they plan tasks like suggesting airline flights but can now also access networks and buy the tickets for you. Which means they have more agency—the ability to autonomously decide, access the real world and get things done."

Much of the concern around Mythos, therefore, comes down to one word: agency. The core fear is that autonomous AI may be able to chain multiple small vulnerabilities into a single crippling attack. Once inside a network, such systems could map architecture, move laterally and generate tools to extract data at extraordinary speed.

Between 2025 and early 2026, frontier models have become significantly more agentic. "These are not meant as cyber-attack systems. They are meant to help solve real-world problems," Velamakanni says. But that same ability to find ways into systems gives them a dual-use edge. That is what worries governments. "Hidden flaws or zero-day vulnerabilities are marketable commodities. An AI tool can find these vulnerabilities in systems," he says. And it can do so far faster than before. Experts say that what once took months may now take days or even hours. That compression of time may be the single biggest disruption. Because cybersecurity has always depended partly on defenders having time to beat hackers at their game.

What happens when that time disappears? Rishi Verma, head of the AI Centre of Excellence of Financial Software and Systems (FSS), says Mythos differs because it operates through a "planner and executor loop", wherein the system not only decomposes goals into tasks that it plans but also executes them iteratively with feedback-driven refinement. "In this sense, if guardrails are insufficient, it could autonomously execute unintended actions at scale." That makes risk non-linear and cascading and also makes it extremely difficult to predict how far an attack can spread, which system it may impact simultaneously, and how it will propagate across various digital networks.